



**To Whom It May Concern,**

I am writing to recommend **Phillip Cantu**, who served as a Software Engineering Apprentice and Junior Software Engineer at Hgraph under my leadership.

During his time with Hgraph, Phillip stood out for his velocity, discipline, and capacity to take full ownership of critical initiatives. He contributed significantly to our core infrastructure and product suite, landing over 140 pull requests across 16 services and packages.

Among his most notable contributions:

- **Enterprise Security & Auth:** Designed and delivered our enterprise SAML single sign-on system end-to-end, enforcing organization security boundaries in Postgres Row-Level Security (RLS) and GraphQL layers alongside JIT user provisioning.
- **AI Product Infrastructure:** Rebuilt the full-stack [hgraph.ai](https://hgraph.ai) agent, implementing Server-Sent Events (SSE) streaming, persistent thread storage, and server-side credential isolation.
- **Analytics & Performance:** Delivered customer-facing API usage reporting from ClickHouse SQL through GraphQL down to the React frontend, introducing skip indexes to optimize query performance across large datasets.

Phillip thrived on our small team of five and contributed far in excess of expectations given his tenure. He is a reliable trusted team player that thrived both with projects that are well within his wheelhouse, such as front-end development, as well as new tasks such as implementing SAML SSO for our self-hosted Supabase stack. I would definitely work with Phillip again and see that he has a bright future in software engineering. Please feel free to contact me if you have any questions about my experience in working with Phil.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink that reads "Tyler McDonald".

**Tyler McDonald**

Founder & Principal Engineer, Hgraph

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